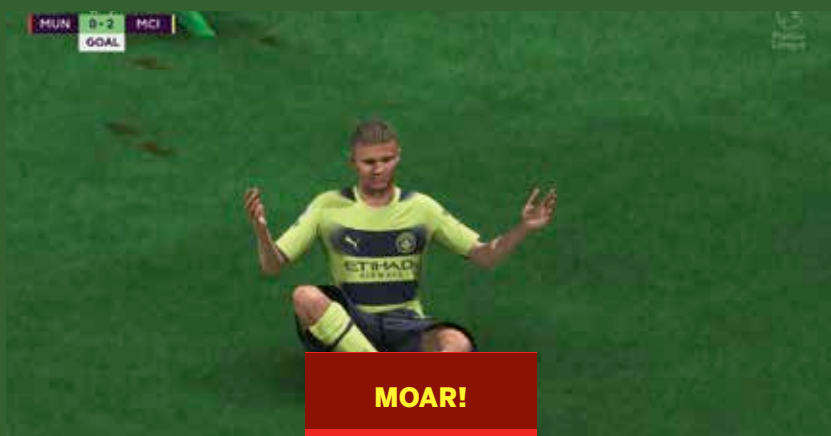




MOAR!

TESTED ON

PS5

DEVELOPER

Electronic Arts, EA
 Vancouver, EA Canada
 & EA Romania, EA
 Romania

PUBLISHER

Electronic Arts, EA
 Sports

PLATFORMS

Xbox Series X and
 Series S, Google
 Stadia, PlayStation 4,
 PlayStation 5,
 Nintendo Switch,
 Xbox One, Microsoft
 Windows

with both on and off-the-ball clashes bringing to life situations that feel less scripted than ever before. Adding to the realism and feel of a simulator are difficult on-the-ball situations where players now end up taking an extra touch or two on the ball when a pass comes to them at pace. Apart from this what we've loved about the game is just how EA has reworked the passing mechanics of FIFA '23. Both short and long passes feel better

weighted, and these passes now have a good, closer-to-reality thump to them the moment you release or trap them. Well-played crosses are now more dangerous than ever, with through balls also capable of opening up the best of defences.

But EA just didn't stop at overhauling the passing mechanics of the game. In fact, they did the same to the shooting, dribbling and set-piece systems as well. Of these, the most important

change is the shooting system. While we were happy with what EA dished out with FIFA '22, the upgrades introduced with this new game just take it to the next level. Despite the goalkeepers now being more overpowered than ever, timed power shots can now blast through even from the most acute of angles. They also feel more accurate than last year. The same is the case for Finesse shots. These don't just nestle into the top corner if you haven't timed them right and added just the right amount of power required to make them perfect.

The revamped set-piece system has been our only gripe with the game, but that's only because we've still not mastered it. Having said that, in moments that we did get it under control, it proved to be an absolute joy. Especially while taking corners. The new system makes mastering set pieces difficult, but it also makes it more rewarding than ever in a FIFA game.

Dribbling for us still remains an area where the game could still improve in. Using a skillful player, dribbles still feel very arcade-like, and not close to what you'd see in real life. But then, that's an element of the game franchise that's actually appreciated by a lot of loyal players.

VERDICT

With FIFA 23, EA has definitely managed to bring a very satisfying football simulator to our homes. With its rich feature set and upgrades to almost all areas of the game, FIFA 23 now feels more real than ever, making it the perfect title for the franchise to come to an end with.

Yes, Ultimate Team is still not perfect, which honestly is the mode where most players will be spending the majority of their time within the game. Yet, it is true that outside Ultimate Team, and on the pixel-generated pitch, the game shines like no other game from the franchise has in recent years. Thus making FIFA 23 an easy title to recommend if you're in the market for a fun football simulator. *